Understanding Qsymia

Schedule IV Rx Phentermine + Topiramate ER Combination · For Chronic Weight Management

WHAT IS QSYMIA & HOW IT WORKS

Phentermine
Appetite suppressant
Works on hypothalamus
Reduces hunger signals

Topiramate
Anticonvulsant
Increases satiety
Makes food taste less appealing

Together: Dual mechanism produces **7–10% average weight loss** when combined with diet and exercise. Extended-release capsules taken once daily in the morning.

DOSING SCHEDULE

Starting	**3.75mg / 23mg — take for 14 days**
Target Dose	**7.5mg / 46mg — recommended maintenance**
Titration	**11.25mg / 69mg — if more weight loss needed**
Maximum	**15mg / 92mg — highest available dose**

Never stop the top dose abruptly — must be tapered gradually to prevent seizures (from topiramate component)

Pregnancy testing required monthly — teratogenic risk!

COMMON SIDE EFFECTS

- Paresthesia — tingling/numbness in hands or feet (common)
- Dizziness
- Dysgeusia — unusual or altered taste
- Insomnia — take only in morning
- Constipation
- Dry mouth

Serious Side Effects — Call Your Doctor

- URGENT Depression or mood changes, anxiety
- URGENT Eye pain, redness, vision changes (glaucoma)
- URGENT Rapid breathing or irregular heartbeat
- URGENT Kidney stones (flank pain)
- URGENT Trouble concentrating or memory problems

DO NOT USE QSYMIA IF:

- CI **Pregnant or planning pregnancy** — causes birth defects (orofacial clefts)
- CI Glaucoma — can worsen acute angle-closure glaucoma
- CI Overactive thyroid (hyperthyroidism)
- CI MAO inhibitor use within the last 14 days
- CI Allergy to phentermine, topiramate, or ingredients

Drug Interactions:
- Alcohol — avoid (increased CNS depression)
- Oral contraceptives — may cause irregular periods (not increased pregnancy risk)
- Non-potassium-sparing diuretics — hypokalemia risk
- Diabetes medications — monitor blood sugar closely

Qsymia Is Part of a Comprehensive Program

Qsymia is most effective when combined with a **doctor-approved reduced-calorie diet, regular exercise, and behavioral changes**. Use effective contraception throughout treatment. Monthly pregnancy tests are required. If you experience any concerning side effects — especially vision changes, mood shifts, or severe chest symptoms — contact us immediately at **(281) 557-0300**.